Janet Swisher

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Documentation Manager | Developer Documentation | Docs-as-code

Summary

I help software teams scale technical documentation for software developers and other technical users through team leadership, docs-as-code systems, and release alignment. At HERE, I led documentation strategy, delivery, and a team of writers, while building a GitHub-based system that achieved 100% release alignment. Earlier at Mozilla, I supported MDN Web Docs' growth through technical writing, community leadership, and agile facilitation. I bring 15+ years combining people leadership with hands-on developer documentation, documentation engineering, and cross-functional partnership with product and engineering teams.

Professional Experience

MTP | Remote
Senior Technical Writer, Chrome Developer Social Content
June 2026 – Present

Embedded with Google's Chrome for Developers social media team, adapting complex web-platform education for high-reach developer channels while maintaining technical accuracy throughout editorial, design, and publication workflows.

- Draft and refine technical content covering web platform APIs, browser capabilities, and Chrome Developer Tools for developer social channels (X, LinkedIn, YouTube).
- Use AI assistance to accelerate content and code example creation, validating technical details against W3C specs, MDN, and Google-owned technical content.
- Partner with design, marketing, production, and developer relations to deliver content that is technically accurate, audience-appropriate, and aligned with channel and corporate requirements.

HERE (here.io, formerly OpenFin) | Remote
Head of Documentation
Nov 2020 – Feb 2026

Led documentation for developers, administrators, and business stakeholders using or evaluating the HERE enterprise browser and SDK platform, including technical integration guidance, administrative workflows, and product-concept content for financial services firms, call centers, and government agencies. Combined hands-on authorship with ownership of content architecture, docs-as-code infrastructure, technical contributor workflows, and cross-functional release leadership.

- Managed a team of 1–2 technical writers: hired, mentored, conducted performance reviews, allocated workload, and supported via 1:1s while encouraging independent ownership for an experienced team.

- Partnered with product management, engineering, QA, and customer solutions to plan and deliver documentation alongside software releases, increasing release-aligned publication from 93% to 100%.
- Planned and led migration from a SaaS documentation platform to a docs-as-code architecture (GitHub, GitHub Actions, Docusaurus, TypeSense), improving integration between documentation and engineering release workflows.
- Owned documentation prioritization and roadmap across multiple audiences and product areas, based on customer feedback, product changes, and support insights, while remaining hands-on with technical research, content development, product testing, and content review.
- Established documentation standards, review practices, and information structures to ensure consistency and quality across developer, administrator, and stakeholder documentation.

Mozilla | Remote
Staff Technical Writer
Jan 2020 – Aug 2020

- Created and maintained developer documentation for web platform technologies and Firefox Developer Tools, including CSS and security topics.
- Researched evolving web technologies and collaborated directly with Firefox engineers to ensure documentation accuracy and synchronization with product releases.

Developer programs and documentation community leadership roles
Mar 2013 – Dec 2019

- Led and supported MDN's global open-source documentation community, coordinating staff and volunteer contributors to expand coverage of key web technologies.
- Facilitated processes for distributed documentation and development teams using a lightweight Large Scale Scrum (LeSS) model, supporting cross-functional planning and delivery.
- Organized contributor initiatives and events across 10+ cities globally, building developer-content community engagement.

Technical Writer/Community Steward
Jun 2010 – Feb 2013

- Authored and edited documentation for open web standards and browser technologies.
- Coordinated volunteer documentation contributors and led focused documentation sprints to improve content coverage and quality.

Lombardi (IBM acquisition) | Austin, Texas
Senior Information Developer
2009 – 2010

- Planned and authored documentation for Teamworks business process management software for both technical administrators and business analysts configuring process workflows, using DITA and related structured-authoring tools.
- Built a proof-of-concept business-process application for creating and maintaining reusable proposal content, integrating DITA content and metadata-driven approval workflows.

Enthought | Austin, Texas
Senior Technical Writer
2004 – 2009

- Planned and authored technical documentation for custom scientific applications and Python libraries used by developers and technical domain experts (geophysicists, materials engineers).
- Developed corporate documentation standards, style guide, and reusable templates.
- Built a Python integration with the RoboHelp API to deliver cross-platform, context-sensitive help.

Technical and Documentation Skills

- **Developer content:** SDK library documentation, developer tools, web platform technologies, technical research and validation, documentation strategy and planning
- **Audience experience:** Developers, administrators, technical domain experts, business stakeholders
- **Documentation engineering:** Docs-as-code, Git/GitHub/GitLab, Docusaurus, TypeSense, Markdown, JSDoc, TypeDoc, Sphinx, reStructuredText, DITA XML
- **Programming and web technologies:** JavaScript, TypeScript, Python; HTML, CSS, browser APIs
- **Documentation leadership:** Team leadership, mentoring, performance management, content strategy, documentation roadmaps, stakeholder collaboration
- **Documentation operations:** Release planning, governance, information architecture, contributor workflows, Agile/LeSS facilitation

Education and Certification

- Certified LeSS Practitioner® — The LeSS Company B.V., 2018
- Technical coursework — University of Texas at Austin and Austin Community College: Data Structures, Analysis of Programs, Java Programming
- University of Chicago — B.A. in Humanities